PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION AND AWARENESS SYSTEM

Internship: Future Interns — Cyber Security
Task: Task 2
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1. Objective

The objective of this task is to identify common phishing email indicators, classify sample emails by risk, and provide practical email security awareness recommendations.

2. Tools Used

- Google Docs for report preparation
- GitHub for documentation and project files
- Manual analysis of fictional sample email text

3. Methodology

Three fictional sample emails were reviewed manually. Their wording, urgency, requests for sensitive information, and available context were considered. Each email was assigned a preliminary classification based on the text provided.

No real email accounts were accessed. Email headers, sender authenticity, links, and attachments were not tested.

4. Sample Email Analysis

Email 1: Class Timetable Update

Subject: Class timetable update

Classification: Likely safe based on the provided text.

Reason: The message gives a routine announcement and does not request passwords or verification codes. However, the sender and any links have not been verified.

Email 2: Account Needs Attention

Subject: Your account needs attention

Classification: Suspicious — verification required.

Reason: The message warns about account restrictions without sufficient context. The recipient should verify the sender independently and avoid unexpected links.

Email 3: Urgent Account Closure

Subject: Urgent — account will be closed

Classification: Phishing indicators present.

Reason: The message creates extreme urgency and asks the recipient to share a password and verification code. These are strong warning signs of phishing.

5. Common Phishing Indicators

- Urgent threats or pressure to act quickly.
- Requests for passwords or verification codes.
- Unexpected links and attachments.
- Sender addresses that do not match the claimed organization.
- Unusual wording or inconsistent branding.

6. Security Recommendations

1. Never share passwords or verification codes by email.
2. Avoid opening unexpected links and attachments.
3. Verify requests through official websites or known contact details.
4. Report suspicious emails to the relevant IT or security team.
5. Enable multi-factor authentication.
6. Keep devices, browsers, and security software updated.

7. Limitations

The examples used in this task are fictional training samples. The classification was based only on the supplied text. No real email headers, sender identities, links, or attachments were analyzed. Therefore, this work demonstrates manual awareness-based classification rather than a fully automated detection system.

8. Conclusion

The task demonstrates how urgency, requests for confidential information, and insufficient context can help identify potential phishing emails. Independent verification and safe email practices reduce the risk of phishing attacks.